

Topic 7.1

7.1: Comments on Reading Assignments for Module 6

The idea of an abstract data type (ADT) at first seems ludicrous: You're creating a type that you can't ever declare a variable of. However, ADTs quite usefully serve as a common ancestral type, and we'll see an important example in Module 10.

In multiple inheritance, one class can inherit characteristics from multiple base classes, much as each of us typically inherits some characteristic traits from our mothers and other traits from our fathers. Multiple inheritance is another issue that begets religious arguments. The basic mechanics of it are simple, and in certain situations I have found it to be quite useful. However, it has been known to create as many problems as it solves. Discussion of all the difficulties is an advanced issue that we will forgo in this course. The reference book by Eckels is an excellent source of this information.

Private derivations allow us to preserve the integrity of a derived type by preventing access to members of the base class that could cause problems in the derived class.

Topic 7.2 (<https://onlinelearning.berkeley.edu/courses/2291660/pages/topic-7-dot-2>)